

Note

Programs and activities which require a UAC prompt are marked with a shield icon. If you are an Administrator, starting these programs would require an elevation; if you are a standard user without access to the administrator password, you will not be able to perform such tasks, or launch such applications.

6.1.2 Making Changes To The Way UAC Is Implemented

UAC is enabled by default under Vista: on new installations, the first user account created is a local administrator account with UAC enabled. All subsequent accounts are then created as standard users. If Vista was installed as an upgrade from Windows XP, and if Vista detects that the XP system only has an Administrator as the only active local administrator account, Windows Vista leaves the account enabled and places the account under UAC. The built-in Administrator account of Vista, by default, cannot log on to the computer in safe mode.

There are several ways one can work with the UAC feature of Vista. You might want to “elevate” and run an application once, or you might want to give a certain application admin privileges every time it runs and thus always run it elevated; finally, you might want to disable UAC altogether. Typical scenarios are thus:

Scenario 1: Request an application to run elevated one time

This is the scenario that will be the mostly common. Here, say you need to run a program which requires a system-access—this could be as simple as wanting to move a folder from one place to another, or having to uninstall a program.

1. When you start the application or a task which require elevation, a User Account Control prompt is displayed
2. Verify that you know the program to be trustworthy, i.e. confirm that the details presented match the request you initiated
3. In the User Account Control dialog box, click Continue to start the application

The application or the task will now run elevated, with the required permissions.